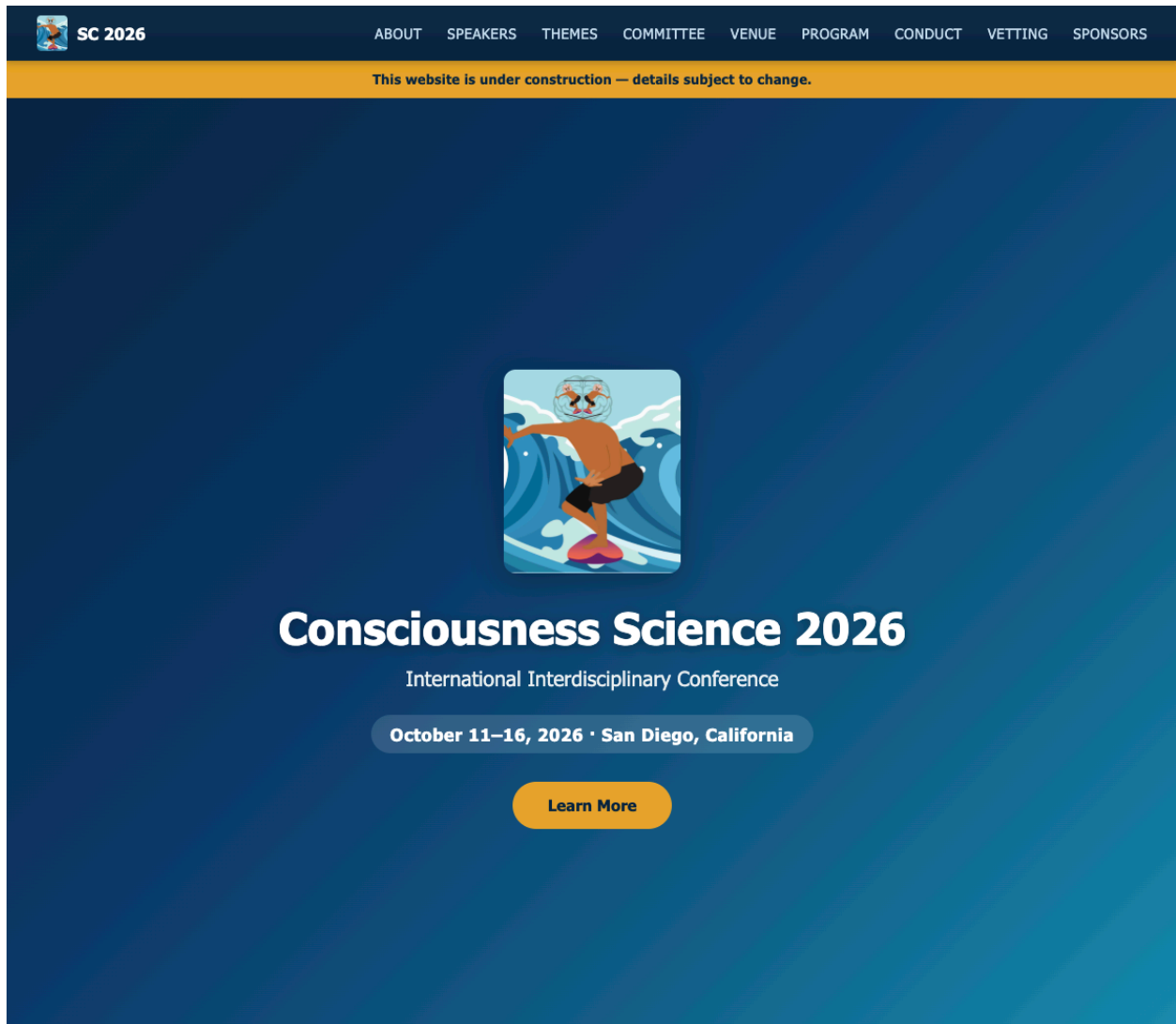


Conference website





SC 2026

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Roger Penrose

University of Oxford

REMOTE



Dean Radin

Institute of Noetic Sciences



Steen Rasmussen

Univ. of Southern Denmark & Santa Fe Institute



Terry Sejnowski

Salk Institute for Biological Studies



Susan Schneider

Florida Atlantic University



Sara Imari Walker

Arizona State University

WAITING TO RECONFIRM



Helané Wahbeh

Institute of Noetic Sciences



Mike Wiest

Wellesley College

Conference Themes

Exploring the frontiers of consciousness research across disciplines.

Neural Correlates of
Consciousness

Predictive Coding &
Consciousness

Theories of Consciousness

Free will, locality, causation, and
consciousness

Quantum Brain Biology

Origins of Life & Consciousness

Can AI Be Conscious?

Psychedelic and Consciousness

Consciousness & Reality

'Psi' & Alien Consciousness

The Hard Problem &
Phenomenology

Non-local Consciousness
Hypotheses

**SC 2026**[ABOUT](#) [SPEAKERS](#) [THEMES](#) [COMMITTEE](#) [VENUE](#) [PROGRAM](#) [CONDUCT](#) [VETTING](#) [SPONSORS](#)

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Scientific Committee

Conference leadership and organization.

CHAIR

**Arnaud Delorme**

Chair
UC San Diego

CO-CHAIRS

**Susan Schneider**

Co-Chair
Florida Atlantic University

**Thomas Brophy**

Co-Chair
Institute of Noetic Sciences

**Tracy Brandmeyer**

Co-Chair
Cognigenics

Venue

Paradise Point Resort & Spa — San Diego, California — October 11–16, 2026

Paradise Point Resort & Spa is a 44-acre island resort set on Mission Bay, offering a serene tropical setting just minutes from downtown San Diego and its vibrant academic community including UC San Diego, the Salk Institute, and Scripps Research.

The meeting will feature:

- Sunday Oct 11 – Friday Oct 16 (five and 1/2 days)
- Modern, spacious, waterfront Conference Center
- Plenary lectures and concurrent sessions
- Poster presentations and exhibits
- Curated experiential and artistic events
- Interdisciplinary workshops
- Social events, e.g. Luau and beach party





Attendance & Conduct Policy

San Diego, California · October 11–16, 2026

Effective for all registered attendees, speakers, staff, sponsors, and media

Consciousness Science 2026 exists to advance substantive, candid, and constructive dialogue on the science of consciousness and related interdisciplinary research. Attendees include neuroscientists, clinicians, philosophers, physicists, computational researchers, and scholars from related fields — people who bring deep expertise and diverse perspectives. The quality of that dialogue depends on an environment of mutual respect, professional courtesy, and shared commitment to the mission.

This policy applies to every person present at any conference activity — sessions, receptions, social events, poster sessions, workshops, and ancillary gatherings — for the full duration of October 11–16, 2026. By registering, you agree to abide by these standards. Violations may result in immediate removal without refund and preclusion from future events.

The Conference Standard

Engage and interact with one another. Don't lecture or ignore one another. Talk to each other, not about each other. Learn. Contribute. Leave the room better than you found it.

Professional Conduct & Community Standards

The conference is a place for the exchange of hard-won expertise and genuine ideas. We expect every participant to bring their full professional self and to extend the same courtesy to others.

What We Ask of You

- **Be present and engaged.** Participate actively in sessions. Ask questions. Challenge ideas respectfully.
- **Please communicate in a respectful, professional, and constructive way** toward all attendees, speakers, staff, volunteers, and vendors.
- **Be considerate** of the time and attention of speakers, moderators, and fellow attendees.
- **Critique ideas, not individuals.** Disagreement is welcome; personal disparagement is not.
- **Be mindful of your surroundings.** If you observe a dangerous situation or a fellow attendee in distress, alert conference staff immediately.
- **Silence or disable your mobile device** before entering any session room.
- **Arrive on time.** Late arrivals disrupt speakers and fellow attendees; if you must arrive late, enter quietly and take the nearest available seat.
- **Please respect personal boundaries** and obtain clear consent before any physical contact.

Zero Tolerance: Sexual Harassment & Discrimination

Zero Tolerance

Sexual harassment and discrimination of any kind are absolutely prohibited. A single violation is grounds for immediate removal from the conference and permanent preclusion from future events. There are no second chances.

Donor & Speaker Vetting

Transparency and accountability in conference funding and participation

Epstein Disclosure

The predecessor of this conference, *The Science of Consciousness* (TSC), received a \$50,000 donation from Jeffrey Epstein in 2017. Several speakers and organizers from previous editions of the conference were named in the Epstein files released in early 2026. The former conference director publicly acknowledged these connections and cancelled the original TSC 2026.

Consciousness Science 2026 has been reorganized under new leadership and governance. We are committed to full transparency regarding past funding and to ensuring that no future donations come from individuals or entities with ties to exploitation, trafficking, or serious criminal conduct.

Our commitment: All donors and major sponsors are screened through a structured vetting protocol before any funds are accepted. Any flagged results trigger mandatory manual review by the organizing committee.

Vetting Protocol

We have adopted a systematic, seven-step web-screening protocol for vetting all donors, sponsors, and invited speakers. The protocol uses publicly available information and produces a structured risk assessment for each individual or entity.

The Seven Steps

- 1 Identity Resolution** — Confirm the correct individual or entity using public profiles, company records, and biographical sources.
- 2 Criminal and Legal History** — Search for criminal charges, civil litigation, settlements, and regulatory actions via news outlets, court records, and government enforcement agencies.
- 3 Association with Known High-Risk Figures** — Screen for documented relationships with individuals involved in major scandals, including Epstein-related reporting, flight logs, and financial ties.
- 4 Reputation Risk Screening** — Search for controversies, allegations, and investigations, assessing whether they are verified by multiple independent sources.
- 5 Philanthropy and Institutional Relationships** — Review donation history and institutional affiliations, flagging cases where institutions have previously returned donations.
- 6 Political Exposure and Sanctions** — Check government sanction lists and politically exposed person databases for foreign influence or corruption concerns.
- 7 Summary Risk Scoring** — Assign a categorical risk score (0–3) based on findings. Any Epstein-related result, criminal conviction, or multiple independent allegations of serious misconduct triggers automatic escalation and additional review and discussion by the chairs.